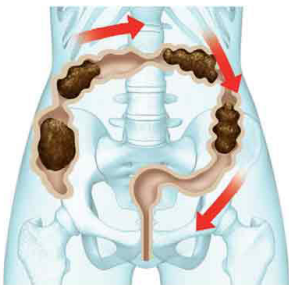


## Colon movements

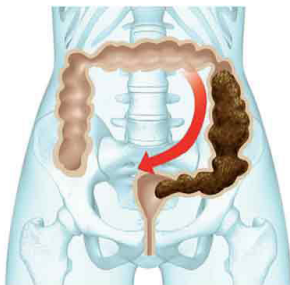
Three types of muscular movement push waste along the colon as it is turned into feces. These slow movements are made by smooth muscles that run along and around the walls of the large intestine.



**Segmentation** movements are produced by a series of short contractions all along the colon that mix and churn feces but do not move them.



**Peristalsis** movements involve small contractions that pass along the colon in waves and push feces toward the rectum.



**Mass** movements are extra-strong contractions that happen three or four times a day after eating and push feces into the rectum.

## Pushed outside

As feces is pushed into the rectum, it stretches the rectum wall. This triggers the need to go to the bathroom. The anal sphincter muscles relax, and the rectum wall contracts to push the feces out through the anus.

Bladder stores urine

